2.1.2 Creating a website using the command-line interface

If you have already built your application using Visual Studio, you may feel like skipping this step. However, I recommend that you try this approach to creating your application too because the process reveals one or two exciting things hidden from you by the new project creation wizard within Visual Studio.

The CLI is a text-based tool for executing commands against the dotnet.exe tool, both of which were installed as part of the SDK. The entry point to the CLI is the `dotnet` command, which is used to execute .NET SDK commands and run a .NET application. You will be using it for its first purpose in the section that follows. The default installation of the SDK adds the `dotnet` tool to your PATH variable, so you can execute commands against it from anywhere on your system.

The CLI tools can be invoked using any command shell you like, including the Windows Command Prompt, Bash, Terminal, or PowerShell (for which there is a cross-platform version). I will refer to the *shell* as the terminal from now on, mainly because it is named within VS Code. The following steps do not assume you are using VS Code to execute the commands, but you can do so using the integrated terminal VS Code provides.

First, create a folder named WebApplication1 in a suitable location on your system, then navigate to it using the terminal, or open the folder within VS Code. If you have chosen to use VS Code, you can access the terminal by pressing Ctrl-`. At the command prompt, type the following commands, pressing the Enter key after each one.

Listing 2.1 Creating Razor Pages application using the CLI